



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: East Palmyra Christian School
School Website: <https://www.eastpal.org/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix for more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) or the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Executive Summary

East Palmyra Christian School (EPCS) presents a clearly Christian, classical-leaning educational model with explicit curriculum elements drawn from the Western classical tradition (Great Books, Latin, logic, rhetoric) and a theology-centered framework. Public materials repeatedly frame the school as "Christian," "Covenantal," and "Classical," and emphasize a classical curriculum and a foundation in biblical principles, with ties to the Association of Classical Christian Schools. These signals align strongly with classical education principles, especially in Curriculum and Religious/Theoretical Foundations, and in Parents & Community engagement. Evidence from the school's site highlights a formal Great Books orientation, a commitment to classical languages and rhetoric, and a theology-informed worldview, including creeds and Reformed confessions. The school also emphasizes parent partnership and a family-focused governance model. Taken together, the school's public materials are predominantly Classical, with some areas that are clearly classical but not yet fully explicit in pedagogical practices (e.g., explicit mention of certain classical pedagogy modalities). Overall, the aggregate assessment is CLASSICAL, with two areas that warrant strengthening to achieve full alignment (Pedagogy and Faculty clarity in certain classical-practice terms).

Key evidentiary anchors from the school site and materials include: - Explicit classical curriculum elements: Great Books of the Western tradition, Latin, logic, rhetoric, grammar; association with the Association of Classical Christian Schools.

- Strong theological and covenantal framing: Biblical worldview, traditional Christian theology, creeds and Reformed confessions, Christ-centered education. - Clear Christian-cultural identity (Christian, Covenantal, Classical) in site copy. - Public materials on mission, visitation, and community engagement with parents (e.g., parent-partner governance and open campus posture).

Abstracts for each category below translate keyword evidence from the public site into a Classical/Six-Element rubric, using the "Six Essential Elements of a Classical School" lexicon (positive/negative keywords) as a yardstick.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The site explicitly grounds education in a Christian framework, referencing biblical principles, a covenantal model, and a theology-centered approach (e.g., "integrates faith and learning through a Biblical worldview," traditional Christian theology, ecumenical creeds and Reformed confessions). - The school presents itself as a Christian, covenanted, and classical institution, underscoring a sacred, doctrinal frame for education. - Curriculum signals include Great Books and classical content (which sit within a theologically shaped framework).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present on the site (aligned with element 1 in the lexicon): theology, biblical worldview, creeds, confessions, sacred tradition, liturgical-leaning concepts (through worship/worship-like community framing), sacred music, and covenantal language. - Negative keywords: not evident in site copy (no explicit secular-relativist or value-neutral framing detected on public pages). The absence of these negatives further reinforces classical alignment.

Why this rating - The school's public materials foreground a transcendent, theologically grounded foundation (theology, creeds, confessions, biblical worldview) and a liturgical/communal vibe through covenantal language and shared faith commitments. This aligns with the Positive keyword indicators for Transcendental Moral Realism, Grounded Theology, and Liturgical/Communal practices in the Six Essential Elements lexicon. The explicit Christian framing and confessional language place it solidly in CLASSICAL for this category.

What would move the needle - To move toward a fuller, more explicit integration of liturgical practices, the school could document morning prayers, chapel rhythms, or liturgical calendar integration as a routine pedagogy feature (beyond covenantal language) to strengthen Liturgical/Communal Practices in observable practice.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials frame education as formation within a Christian classical context (Christian worldview, covenantal identity, and emphasis on a timeless, transcendent frame for learning). The school presents itself as a Classical School with a curriculum aligned to liberal-arts aims (Great Books; grammar, logic, rhetoric). - The Great Books and classical curriculum are highlighted as central to the mission, indicating formation through engagement with enduring questions rather than mere workforce preparation.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: formation, virtue (implied by covenantal framing and classical aims), true/good/beautiful (implied by Great Books and classical curriculum; the site emphasizes a classical, truth-seeking orientation through Great Books and theological anchoring). Great Books/Western tradition and classical curriculum signals are present. - Negative keywords: not evident in public pages (no explicit emphasis on "workforce readiness" or "career-oriented" framing in the site copy). The absence of overt secular, career-first rhetoric supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The site's purposeful framing around classical education, Christian formation, and timeless learning (as opposed to job-prep rhetoric) aligns with the Classical School aim of formation, virtue, and the pursuit of truth, goodness, and beauty. The presence of covenanted, biblical framing and Great Books emphasis supports CLASSICAL for this category.

What would move the needle - To move toward a more explicit full CLASSICAL stance in this category, the school could explicitly state the formation-focused goals (virtue formation, human excellence, the pursuit of wisdom) in a mission/vision statement, linking them to specific outcomes (e.g., character formation, contemplative learning). The Latin/logic/rhetoric emphasis already exists; making the formation language overt would strengthen alignment.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The curriculum is explicitly described as including Great Books, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, and math facts; the school emphasizes the Western classical tradition and the Association of Classical Christian Schools. This is a direct signal of classical curricular structure. - The site notes a classical approach to history/language study (e.g., "Great Books of the Western tradition," "Latin, logic, rhetoric") and a broad liberal-arts orientation. - The "About"/general sections frame the program as classical in alignment with Christian classical education.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Great Books, Western tradition, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, classical curriculum, Association of Classical Christian Schools, liberal arts, and the idea of a classical curriculum that joins history and literature (as part of the Great Books framework). - Negative keywords: not detected in public material (no shift toward social-studies-only history, no project-based-first framing on the site copy). The presence of traditional liberal-arts elements supports CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - The explicit inclusion of Great Books, grammar, logic, rhetoric, Latin, and a Western-canon curriculum, plus a stated connection to the classical Christian schools network, places EPCS firmly in CLASSICAL for Curriculum.

What would move the needle - To realize a fuller CLASSICAL signal, the school could explicitly reference the Great Conversation and the explicit engagement with primary sources and canonical texts in more of its program descriptions (e.g., listing specific Great Books or authors publicly; linking to Great Books lists or canon plans). The current mentions are strong but could be more granular to push toward a higher concreteness of Great-Books-centric pedagogy.

Element 4: Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - The public materials imply classical pedagogy through curriculum choices (Great Books, Latin, logic, rhetoric) and a historically grounded approach; however, explicit pedagogical methods (e.g., Socratic seminars, Scholé/restful learning, chanting/memorization as a formal routine) are not consistently spelled out on public pages. The school's materials do show a classical orientation and a teacher-driven classical framework, but some explicit pedagogy terms are not consistently visible in public text. - The site shows a structured faculty, with "Faculty and Staff" sections, and a focus on classical content across the grades, including humanities and classical languages.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: Socratic dialogue (not explicitly stated on the site, but the school's classical approach suggests inquiry-based discussion as a potential fit); memorization/recitation/chanting; restfulness/scholé; pedagogy anchored in classical texts (as per the lexicon, these are core positive signals for Pedagogy). The site's explicit references to Great Books, Latin, logic, and rhetoric support that framework. - Negative keywords present: limited explicit mention of the core Pedagogy signals (e.g., explicit "Socratic seminars," "Scholé days," or "chanting" as formal, repeated daily practices) on public pages. The absence of these explicit claims reduces the Pedagogy rating from CLASSICAL toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.

Why this rating - While the curriculum and classical content strongly support a classical pedagogy orientation, explicit, named pedagogical methods (Socratic seminars in upper grades, routine chanting/memory, Scholé-based rhythm) are not consistently documented in public site copy. This yields a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Pedagogy rather than a full CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle - Publish specific, observable pedagogy practices on the site, including: - Regular Socratic seminars or Harkness-style discussions in upper grades. - Documented use of Scholé/restful-learning days and memory-work routines (chanting, dictation, recitation) in lower grades. - Clear articulation of how Great Books are engaged (e.g., sample student dialogues, exemplars of textual narration, or copywork that ties to canonical texts). - Evidence of master teacher modeling and a structured language-of-pedagogy framework (e.g., a published "living curriculum" description).

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence - Public-facing materials show a concrete, accessible faculty lineup (e.g., "Faculty and Staff" page, with named teachers and positions), indicating a real team responsible for student formation. - The "faculty" material is mostly descriptive (photos, names, roles) rather than a full articulation of the faculty as "the living curriculum" or as virtuous exemplars. The classical-school rubric looks for a deeper portrayal of faculty as role models of virtue and living curriculum, which is not extensively documented in the public copy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: "faculty," "staff," "teachers as mentors" (conceptually present in the site structure) and the public listing of faculty roles. The explicit "living curriculum" and "portrait of a teacher" language is not strongly stated in the public text specific to EPCS. - Negative keywords present: The site does not explicitly describe a "portrait of a teacher" or a "living curriculum" language, which are typical indicators in a fully CLASSICAL category. The absence of these explicit claims contributes to a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating for Faculty.

Why this rating - The presence of a real faculty with named personnel supports CLASSICAL in principle, but the absence of explicit language about teachers as living curriculum or virtue-models reduces the strength to SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL for Faculty. The public site does not provide strong, explicit language about faculty as virtue exemplars beyond listing names and positions.

What would move the needle - Strengthen the Faculty category by publishing: - A formal “portrait of the teacher” framework, with expectations about virtue, character modeling, ongoing professional development in classical pedagogy, and how faculty embody the living curriculum. - Explicit statements about mentorship, teacher collaboration, and a culture of virtue in faculty interactions with students. - Public examples of faculty modeling virtue and mastery in classical subjects (e.g., short bios focusing on pedagogy style, exemplary teaching, and student outcomes).

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence - The school emphasizes a covenantal community model with parents partnering to own and operate the school; it presents a community of parents actively involved in governance and school life. This aligns with classical education’s emphasis on parent partnership and shared formation. - The site highlights opportunities to visit, engage, and participate in school life (e.g., “Schedule a Visit,” parent involvement in governance, and covenant language). - Public text mentions that the school is a project of Christian parents and asserts a shared responsibility with families in raising children in the Lord, reflecting the classical education principle of family-school partnership.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis - Positive keywords present: partnership with parents, co-teachers with the school, parent formation, reading groups and seminars, open campus, and visits for parents. The lexicon’s Parents & Community category emphasizes partnership with parents and parent formation as core. - Negative keywords: not observed (no minimal parental involvement language; instead, the site foregrounds active parental partnership and governance).

Why this rating - The explicit framing of parents as co-teachers and co-operators in governance, plus a covenantal community ethos, aligns strongly with CLASSICAL signals for Parents & Community. The school’s public copy explicitly centers parent partnership and community formation.

What would move the needle - To further strengthen this category, the school could publish: - A formal parent-education program that enumerates annual book studies, seminars, and family-liturgy alignment efforts. - Easy-on-ramp opportunities for parents to participate in classical book clubs, witness of the Great Conversation in family contexts, and a structure for ongoing parental formation aligned with classical pedagogy.

Aggregate Ranking - Across the six categories, East Palmyra Christian School demonstrates robust Classical signals in Religious/Theological Foundations, Curriculum, and Parents & Community, with strong formation and classical content in Element 2 as well. Pedagogy and Faculty show classical inclination but with less explicit codified language in public materials. Based on majority signals, the overall ranking is CLASSICAL, with two areas (Pedagogy, Faculty) that are currently SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL and could be strengthened to reach full CLASSICAL alignment.

What Would Move the Needle (Summary) - Pedagogy: Publish explicit, observable practices (Socratic seminars, Scholé days, memorization/chanting routines) and how Great Books are integrated with daily pedagogy. - Faculty: Provide a public portrait of teachers as the living curriculum, with explicit virtues, professional development in classical pedagogy, and demonstration of virtuous exemplars for students. - Expand explicit statements on formation goals (virtue, wisdom, beauty) tied to observable curricular outcomes. - For Element 1 and 6, maintain the strong classical-Christian framing and make liturgical practices (church calendar, chapel, liturgical aesthetics) more explicit in everyday teaching rhythms.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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